



Notice of Privacy Practices

(Revised 5/5/2017)

This notice describes how medical information about you may be used and disclosed and how you can get access to this information. Please review it carefully.

Performance Rehab Associates at Lake Norman, in accordance with the Health Insurance Portability and Accountability Act (HIPAA) Privacy Rule, (the "Privacy Rule") and applicable state law, is committed to protecting the privacy of your protected health information ("PHI"). PHI includes information about your health condition and the care and treatment you receive from the Practice. The Practice understands that information about your health is personal. This Notice explains how your PHI may be used and disclosed to third parties. This Notice also details your rights regarding your PHI. The Practice is required by law to maintain the privacy of your PHI and to provide you with this Privacy Notice detailing the Practice's legal duties and practices with respect to your PHI. Performance Rehab Associates at Lake Norman is also required by law to abide by the terms of this Notice.

Examples of uses and disclosures of protected health information for treatment, payment and health care operations:

For treatment: Information obtained by a physician, massage therapist, or other member of our health care team will be recorded in your medical record and used to help decide what care may be right for you. We may also provide information to others providing you care. This will help them stay informed about your care.

For payment: We request payment from your health insurance plan. Health plans need information from us about your medical care. Information provided to health plans may include your diagnosis, procedures performed or recommended care.

For health care operations:

- We may use your medical records to assess quality and improve services.
- We may use and disclose medical records to review the qualifications and performance of our health care providers and to train our staff.
- We may contact you to remind you about appointments and give you information about treatment alternatives or other health-related benefits and services.
- We may use and disclose your information to conduct or arrange for services including: Medical quality review by your health plan; accounting, legal, risk management and insurance services; and audit functions, including fraud and abuse detection and compliance programs.

OTHER USE & DISCLOSURES THAT ARE REQUIRED OR PERMITTED BY LAW

- Performance Rehab Associates at Lake Norman may also use and disclose your PHI without your consent or authorization in the following instances:
- **Appointment Reminders** -We may use and disclose your PHI to remind you by telephone, text, email or mail about appointments you have with us, annual exams, or to follow up on missed or cancelled appointments.
- **Individuals Involved in Your Care or Payment for Your Care** – We may disclose to a family member, other relative, a close friend, or any other person identified by you. Certain limited PHI that is directly related to that person's involvement with your care or payment for your care. We may use or disclose your PHI to notify those persons of your location or general condition. This includes in the event of your death unless you have specifically instructed us otherwise. If you are unable to specifically agree or object, we may use our best judgment when communicating with your family and others.
- **Disaster Relief** - We also may use or disclose your PHI to an authorized public or private entity to assist in disaster relief efforts. This will be done to coordinate information with those organizations in notifying a family member, other relative, close friend or other individual of your location and general condition.
- **De-identified Information** – Performance Rehab Associates at Lake Norman may use and disclose health information that may be related to your care but does not identify you and cannot be used to identify you.